Policy 18 – Backup, Business Continuity & Disaster Recovery

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2. Policy Objectives and Scope

2.1 Purpose – Ensure critical data and services can be restored within acceptable time and data-loss targets after disruption.

2.2 Scope – Production databases, file stores, configuration repositories, and essential SaaS services.

2.3 Backup Strategy & Frequency

- Perform full backups daily for critical production data; retain at least 30 days online.
- Snapshot infrastructure-as-code and configs before each major change.

2.4 Backup Storage & Encryption

- Store backups in geographically separate region or provider.
- Encrypt at rest using managed keys; restrict restore permissions to limited roles.

2.5 Recovery Testing & RTO/RPO

- Test restores quarterly; record actual Recovery Time Objective (RTO) and Recovery Point Objective (RPO).
- Compare results to targets and adjust strategy if exceeded.

2.6 Business Continuity Plan Maintenance

- Keep concise BCP playbook covering loss of workspace, key staff, or SaaS outage.
- Review BCP annually or after significant operational change.

2.7 Disaster Recovery Activation & Roles

- Define DR trigger thresholds; Incident Commander authorises activation.
- Maintain contact list for critical vendors and service providers.

3. Policy Compliance

3.1 Measurement – ≥ 95 % backup success rate; latest quarterly restore test documented and within target RTO/RPO.

3.2 Exceptions – Systems excluded from backup require documented justification and alternative mitigation.

3.3 Non-Compliance – Missed backups or failed restore tests escalate to leadership for immediate remediation.

3.4 Continual Improvement – Incorporate findings from DR exercises and technology advances into backup/BCP strategy.